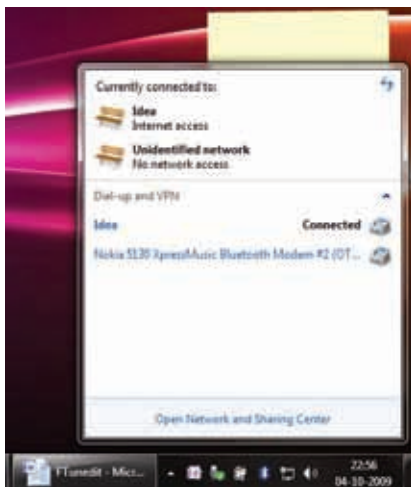


6 Connecting to the Network

6.1 View Available Networks

Windows 7 makes it a very simple to view and connect to networks on your laptop. Just click on the network icon in the taskbar. View Available Networks displays all your wireless and wired networking options including Wi-Fi, mobile broadband, dial-up, LAN or corporate VPN. One more click on any of them, and you're connected. It is an awesome feature for netbooks as the number of steps required to get connected to internet is reduced and you can instantly get going with your web-browsing.



View Available Networks window to quickly get connected

6.2 Domain Join

A domain is a type of computer network commonly found in the workplace. (In geek-speak, it's a collection of computers that's centrally administered and operates under common rules.)

Windows 7 Professional and Ultimate come with a handy utility that lets you join domains quickly and securely. Just follow the easy-to-use wizard, which prompts you to enter your network credentials. You will be in business in no time.

6.3 Windows Connect Now

Windows Connect Now makes it easier to set up a wireless network at home or work. Just buy a Wi-Fi router with a "Compatible with Windows 7" logo. The first time you connect, Windows will walk you through all the necessary setup steps—including naming your network and turning on the router's security features. After that, you need not remember your network credentials when you connect new computers. Just push the Wi-Fi Protected Setup button on your router and it will automatically send the network settings to your computer.